with guns, swords, and cannons, and despite being extremely outnumbered, Clive was feeling bolstered by his recent retaking of the city of Calcutta. On June 23rd, 1757, these forces met at Palashi, West Bengal, about 150 kilometers (93 miles) from the EIC's base.

Outwardly, it seemed pure folly to enter into battle in such conditions, but Robert Clive had a secret: he'd bribed a member of Siraj ud-Daulah's party —Mir Jafar—to defect in exchange for political power under British rule in the area. Clive was confident in his plans, yet when the battle began that morning at Palashi, there was no sign that Jafar would be sending any assistance his way. Instead, Jafar's regiment appeared on the battlefield with orders to hold back until they were given a signal, either to back the British or the Indians.

Nevertheless, Clive and his 3,000 men fought their attackers for several hours, cleverly holding off the advance without losing a great number of soldiers. Around midday, heavy rains set in, soaking the gunpowder stores on the Mughal and French side. Clive's troops wrestled with tarps to protect their own stores and subsequently gained substantially on their enemies in the following gun battle. One of Siraj's most important men, Mir Madan Khan, was killed by cannon fire, leaving the Mughal leader extremely distraught.

Seeing Siraj so close to retreat, Mir Jafar sent word to Clive to push onward. Soon afterward, ud-Daulah left the battlefield altogether, never having set foot in the fray. He took 2,000 troops with him but did not call his remaining soldiers back from the entanglement. Jafar's own regiment of several thousand troops remained, and eventually, there were none left but his and Clive's soldiers. Clive occupied the nawab's empty military camp by five o'clock that evening, and the battle was finished.

Robert Clive and his allies had not just banished Siraj ud-Daulah from their cities; they had effectively changed the political fabric of the province. As promised, Mir Jafar was appointed the new nawab of Bengal, answerable to the administration of the East India Company. Starting in the year 1758, Company Rule was established throughout a massive chunk of eastern India. It was also called Company Raj, "raj" being the Hindu word for rule. Company Rule would persist for one hundred years.